

Caleb Tallquist

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SUMMARY

Platform and DevOps engineer with 6+ years running Kubernetes and Terraform infrastructure on AWS and GCP, across high-traffic consumer scale and regulated fintech. I spend most of my time on deploy pipelines, observability, and cloud cost, with product teams as the customer.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (EKS, EC2, S3, IAM, VPC, Lambda, RDS, Transit Gateway, KMS), GCP (GKE, GCS), Route 53, CloudFront, Multi-Account Architecture

Containers & Orchestration: Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, Argo CD, Kustomize, Karpenter, KEDA, Istio, Envoy, Cluster Autoscaling

Infrastructure As Code & Automation: Terraform, Terragrunt, Ansible, Packer, Crossplane, Python, Go, Bash, Backstage

CI/CD & Release Engineering: GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins, Argo Rollouts, Canary And Blue-Green Deploys, Trunk-Based Development, Artifact Caching

Observability & Reliability: Datadog, Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, Splunk, PagerDuty, SLOs And Error Budgets, Incident Response, Postmortems

Security, Data & Networking: HashiCorp Vault, IRSA, SCPs, SOC 2 Controls, Kafka, PostgreSQL, Redis, mTLS, DNS, Load Balancing, Private Networking

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Pelotech

Remote

Senior Platform Engineer

Sep 2025 – Present

- Architected an EKS internal developer platform on Backstage and Argo CD, with golden paths that cut new-service onboarding from three days to under two hours.
- Migrated a client's ECS workloads to EKS with Karpenter and spot node pools, right-sizing requests along the way and trimming monthly compute spend 34%.
- Instrumented OpenTelemetry tracing across a client's Go and Node services, then capped Datadog custom metric cardinality after a tagging change tripled ingest cost.
- Replaced copy-pasted Terraform with a versioned module registry and Terragrunt layout, killing the drift that kept breaking staging and prod parity across three accounts.
- Streamlined GitHub Actions pipelines onto self-hosted spot runners with layer caching, dropping p95 build time from 22 minutes to 6 for the client's main monorepo.
- Introduced SLO and error-budget policy with PagerDuty routing tied to burn rate, which quieted a pager that had been waking engineers on non-actionable disk alerts.
- Traced intermittent ALB 502s to a keep-alive mismatch, where the target's idle timeout expired before the load balancer's, then patched the base Helm chart.

Indeed

Remote

Site Reliability Engineer

Aug 2022 – Sep 2025

- Engineered regional traffic-shifting runbooks and Route 53 health checks for the job-search serving path, making failover a single controlled step instead of manual guesswork.
- Overhauled autoscaling for Kafka consumers that fell behind at evening peak, replacing CPU-based HPA with KEDA on lag depth to hold p99 under 20 seconds.
- Tuned CPU requests across a noisy namespace after profiling showed CFS quota throttling, not saturation, was driving the latency spikes teams kept escalating.
- Drove postmortem practice for a shared platform team, pushing action items into tracked backlog work rather than doc comments nobody read after week one.
- Automated certificate rotation and cluster upgrade prep with Python and Ansible, removing roughly 15 hours of manual toil per upgrade cycle across nine clusters.

Rocket Mortgage

Detroit, MI

Cloud Infrastructure Engineer

Oct 2021 – Aug 2022

- Shipped a Terraform landing zone with AWS Organizations, SCPs, and per-team accounts, giving regulated workloads hard blast-radius boundaries instead of shared-account trust.
- Hardened secrets handling by moving connection strings out of config files into Vault with IRSA-scoped access, which closed a repeat internal audit finding.
- Implemented private-only networking with Transit Gateway and VPC endpoints so borrower-data services reached S3 and KMS without touching a public egress path.
- Standardized golden AMIs through Packer with a monthly rebuild cadence, cutting critical patch rollout across the fleet from about three weeks to four days.

Associate DevOps Engineer

Aug 2020 – Oct 2021

- Developed GitLab CI pipelines to replace aging Jenkins jobs for .NET services, adding dependency caching that took average build time from 18 minutes to 7.
- Refactored brittle deployment shell scripts into idempotent Ansible roles, which ended the snowflake config that made two supposedly identical app servers behave differently.
- Consolidated scattered Splunk alerts into a focused dashboard per service, so whoever held the pager had one place to look instead of six saved searches.

Quicken Loans

Detroit, MI

Software Engineering Intern

Jun 2020 – Aug 2020

- Scripted a Python job to inventory untagged AWS resources against the cost-allocation standard, surfacing 400+ orphaned EC2 volumes and snapshots for cleanup.
- Established runbook documentation for a nightly document-processing batch job that on-call had been restarting from tribal knowledge passed around in chat threads.
- Delivered a small log-parsing utility that flagged failed loan-document uploads, which the support team had previously discovered only when a client called in.

EDUCATION

Hope College

Holland, MI

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science

2016 – 2020